

[Return to Search](#)

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I really follow the Ansar al-Sunna from my heart. I guess I got some of these ideas from the Muslim Brotherhood when I was in Cairo. However, in front of the people I do my best not to appear a fanatic. If I openly declared my belonging to Hag Abdullah's group, it would ruin my position because many people whose support I need belong to the Sufis. Their opposition is very strong. Actually, Hag Abdullah and Hag Omar would like to force me to declare my position in public, but this could put me in a hard position. What I reply is that Islam was preached by Muhammad, and Muhammad did not want any subgroups. He only wanted a single unified group which we called Muslims. We should follow the way of Islam. I uphold the view that the differences are not important, and what is important is that there should be union. The differences that exist are merely of interpretation. But for the Ansar al-Sunna, this kind of explanation is not strong enough. Nevertheless, I am not ready to go further at this time.

159
[Life History Materials](#)

177
[Acculturation And Culture Contact](#)

668
[Political Movements](#)

781
[Religious Experience](#)

795
[Religious Denominations](#)

I am on good terms with the leaders of both religious groups in the village. However, I do not tell my most secret plans to either of them, although both of them individually think that I favor them. When I give speeches, I try to moderate Hag Abdullah's influence by emphasizing the dos rather than the don'ts. I say, "Eat, but don't eat too much because it hurts your stomach and is not good for the health." Hag Abdullah says: "God does not like those who eat much. They will go to hell." I say: "Allah likes cleanliness. If you can't take a bath, perfume yourself, enjoy your time." Hag Abdullah constantly preaches that Muslims must practice self-denial. He says that those who don't pray and follow rituals exactly will go to hell, and Allah will put obstacles in their path

159
[Life History Materials](#)

668
[Political Movements](#)

781
[Religious Experience](#)

793
[Priesthood](#)

here on earth. I prefer simply to state it without reiterating the idea of punishment. I say, "Praying is good. Let's all pray now."

794
Congregations

One of my characteristics that bothers me a lot is my fear of the dark. I am sure you have noticed that when I come to your house at night, somebody always accompanies me. I know they make jokes when someone has to go home with me from the *mastaba* in the evening. I have tried many times to cure myself of this fear. In the British Army I used to carry a flashlight in my pocket in spite of the fact that there were many lights. When I first came to Kanuba I always had it in my pocket until it wore out. When I came to the village in 1946 I tried to hide the fact from the people, but they soon noticed that I feared the dark, in spite of the different  164 excuses I gave, because I always asked someone to accompany me to my house after sundown.

152
Drives And Emotions

159
Life History Materials

828
Ethnopsychology

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